



UNITED STATES

According to newly published research, total US household spending on wireless services has overtaken land-line spending, to account for the bulk of dollars spent on telecom services

BRAZIL

Police arrested 53 people for allegedly stealing \$30 million from online bank accounts. The suspects targeted thousands of online banking customers by sending e-mails containing Trojan horses, a type of virus able to collect information on Internet bank accounts

UNITED KINGDOM

According to a far-reaching UK education report, technology should be moved to the heart of the school curriculum. Former Chief Inspector of Schools, Mike Tomlinson's review has called for the most radical changes to teaching in 50 years

GERMANY

Nico Morawa hurled his handset a distance of 67.5 metres. He is claiming the title of "World Mobile Phone-Chucking Champion." This was set in a cell phone chucking event on October 17. Morawa beat 70 other contestants

CHINA

October 18, Zhang Qingwei, President of the China Aerospace Science and Technology Corp (CASC), said that China will launch its second manned space flight next year. The spacecraft, the Shenzhou VI, will spend five to seven days in space with more than one person aboard

IRAQ

John Martinkus, an Australian journalist, was freed by his captors on October 17 after they Googled his name to check if he was telling the truth about his affiliation with public broadcaster SBS



hacked and turned into a porn site. Following that incidence, a Calcutta proposal will make it mandatory for a cyber-café to not

only register their customers, but also log the Web sites they visit.

The Mumbai police, too, are considering a similar diktat. Under the proposed system, a cyber-café will need a license to operate. The licensing norm will entail café owners shelling out an annual fee, and only those with a photo-identity will have access to cyber-cafés. Registering of customers, and maintenance of customer details will then need to be submitted to Mumbai Police HQ.

Apart from cybercrime, officials are also keen on cutting down on pornography by mandating the use of software filters at the expense of café owners.

Most cyber-café owners are small entrepreneurs looking to make a low-



Illustrations Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

margin living in an increasingly competitive space—estimates put the number of cafés in India at 3 lakh.

Regulations such as these will only remove

from the bottom-line of most of these small businesses. Saboo says, "These new measures are likely to dissuade many Internet users from going to cyber-cafés, and could lead to the closure of almost half of them."

WINDOWS XP STARTER EDITION

Emasculated Windows For India

Microsoft has announced plans to introduce Windows XP Starter Edition to India in 2005—this is the low cost, feature-light variant of its Windows XP operating system. The underlying theme, of course,



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